

Sample Fundamental Movement Pattern Exercises

The following are sample exercises that can help train the fundamental movement patterns relevant to combat sports:

Goblet Squats: This exercise is vital for MMA athletes because it bolsters leg and core strength while enhancing mobility, balance, and posture and directly translates to improved striking, grappling, and movement fluidity in the ring or cage. It mirrors the deep squatting and lifting movements often required in matches, making it a multifaceted tool for comprehensive athletic development.



Push-Ups: This exercise trains the upper body's pushing power, mirroring the pushing movements used in strikes like punches in boxing.



Pull-Ups: This exercise is great for developing pulling strength, which is fundamental for grappling techniques like pulls and clinches, common in sports such as Brazilian jiu-jitsu or judo.



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Medicine Ball Rotational Throws: This exercise is excellent for training rotational power. Rotational movements are integral to most combat sports as they generate power in strikes and contribute to mobility and evasion tactics.



Trap Bar Deadlift: This exercise develops comprehensive strength, targeting key muscles like the gluteals, hamstrings, quadriceps, and lower back, which are essential for powerful strikes, takedowns, and maintaining a grounded stance. The trap bar design also promotes a more neutral spine position, reducing stress on the lower back region.



Romanian Deadlift: This exercise teaches how to perform a hip hinge properly and strengthens muscles of the posterior chain, including the hamstrings, gluteals, and spinal erectors.

